

■IDENTIFICATION AND AUTHENTICATION POLICY

Organization: Blue Ridge Technology Solutions LLC

Control: 3.5.10 - Cryptographic Password Storage

Version: 1.2 | Effective: 2026-01-15

Owner: Nathan Cruz, IT Manager | Approved: Victor Osei, Director of Operations

1. PURPOSE

This policy requires Blue Ridge Technology Solutions LLC to store and transmit only cryptographically protected passwords, per NIST SP 800-171 Rev. 2 control 3.5.10.

2. SCOPE

All Blue Ridge Technology Solutions LLC systems that store or transmit user passwords.

3. REQUIREMENTS

- a. Passwords are never stored in plaintext.
- b. Password storage uses strong one-way hashing (bcrypt, PBKDF2, or Argon2).
- c. Reversible encryption of passwords is prohibited and technically disabled.
- d. Passwords are transmitted only over encrypted channels (TLS 1.2+).
- e. Nathan Cruz verifies cryptographic password protection settings quarterly.

4. RESPONSIBILITY

Nathan Cruz, IT Manager, ensures password storage and transmission uses cryptographic protection.

5. ENFORCEMENT

Systems storing passwords in plaintext or reversible encryption are immediately remediated.

Signed: Victor Osei, Director of Operations | Blue Ridge Technology Solutions LLC | 2026-01-15